Business Sales Performance Analysis

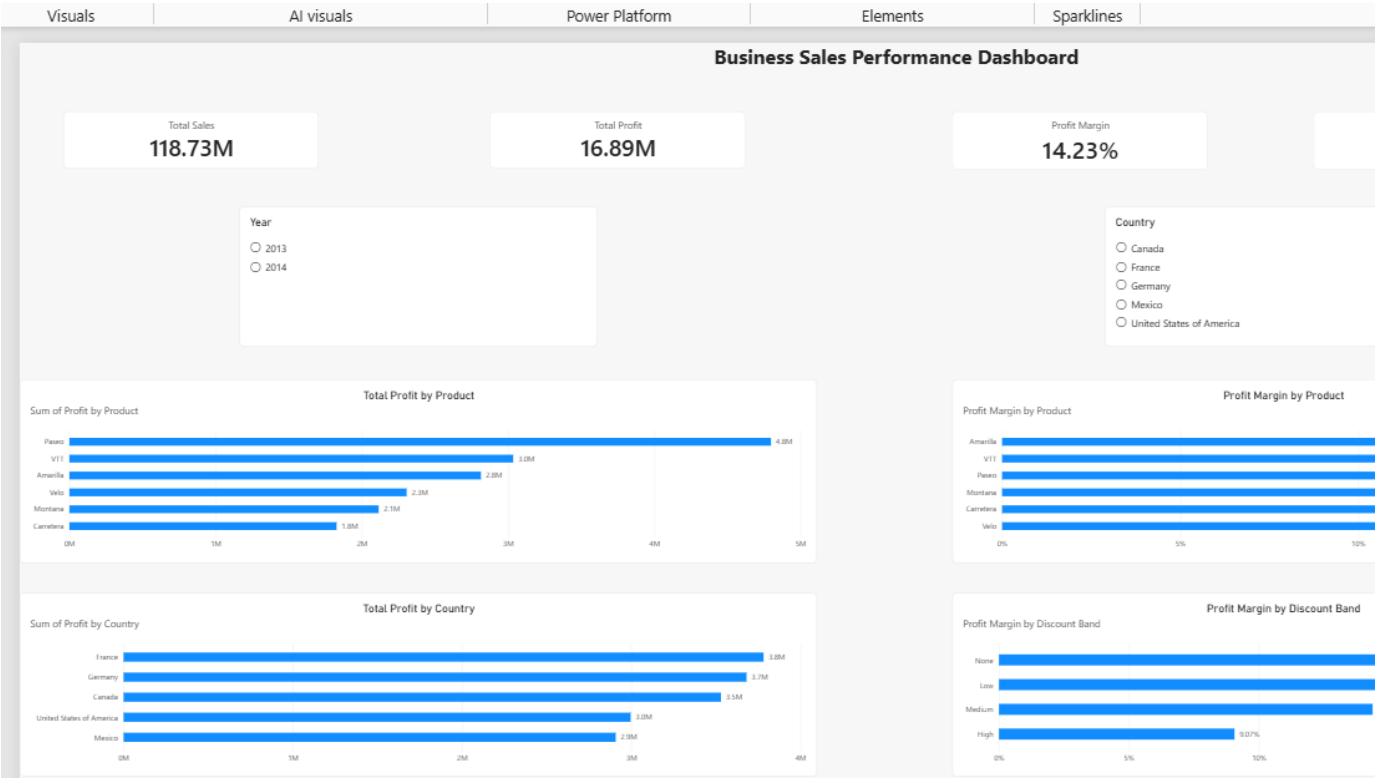
Independent portfolio project | Excel and Microsoft Power BI

Analyzed Microsoft's Financial Sample dataset to compare product and country profitability, evaluate discount bands, and explore sales and profit trends. The dataset is illustrative sample data, not actual company performance.

Business question

Which products, markets, and discount levels are associated with stronger profitability, and how can management use those patterns to prioritize follow-up analysis?

Dashboard overview



Dashboard screenshot from Power BI Desktop. The report includes four KPIs, five visuals, and Year/Country slicers.

Key performance indicators

Total sales	Total profit	Profit margin	Units sold
$118.73M	**$16.89M**	**14.23%**	**1.13M**

Findings

Product performance. Paseo generated approximately $4.80M in total profit, the most of any product. Amarilla had the highest product profit margin (15.86%). Volume and margin should be evaluated separately.

Country performance. France generated about $3.78M in profit; Germany recorded the highest country profit margin (15.66%). High total profit does not necessarily imply the highest margin.

Discount bands. Observed margins declined from 21.86% with no discount to 17.87% (low), 14.39% (medium), and 9.07% (high). These are descriptive associations, not evidence that discounting alone caused lower margins.

Time trend. The dashboard compares monthly sales and profit across the available September–December 2013 and 2014 periods. Because 2013 is only partially represented, raw annual totals are not a like-for-like full-year growth comparison.

Recommendations and next analysis

1. Review discount policies by product and customer segment. Compare incremental volume with the reduction in contribution/profit margin before changing discounts.

2. Protect high-profit products such as Paseo while investigating why Amarilla delivers stronger margin efficiency. Evaluate pricing, cost, and mix rather than assuming one product should replace another.

3. Compare market profitability using both total profit and margin. Investigate differences in country-level product mix, costs, and discount exposure.

4. Validate seasonal patterns using comparable months and additional years before making demand forecasts or staffing decisions.

Methods and tools

Excel: data type and duplicate checks, PivotTables, and sales/profit comparisons. Power BI: DAX profit margin measure, interactive KPI cards, bar charts, monthly line chart, and Year/Country slicers. Profit margin = SUM(Profit) / SUM(Sales).

Limitations

This is a demonstration using a public sample dataset. Results are descriptive and do not establish causation. Some values are rounded for display. The underlying Power BI file should be provided separately for reproducibility.

Dataset: Microsoft Power BI Financial Sample — https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/create-reports/sample-financial-download